What should we actually be measuring?

The tool is built and working. What it asks you to do on a stop is still my draft, and it is the one part nobody outside the shop can settle. Answer what you know, skip what you do not, and use the open boxes — disagreeing with me is the point. HVAC is on its own sheet.

Three ways to answer this, all equally good

Type into it and email the file back · print it and write on it · hand it to Cayden and talk it through

Answer what you know and skip the rest. A page with four answers on it is worth more than a blank one.

Who is answering

So the answers can be attributed in the meeting. Nothing else is collected.

YOUR NAME

ROLE

Four scoring decisions

These are live in the product now, with values I picked as placeholders. They need a name against them.

1 Which checks should be allowed to move the score?

Every check used to average into the customer's number. That meant “Maintenance clean cycle — performed” — work we were paid to do — raised the score of the appliance we did it to, and an evaporator frost pattern (your 4 is the next tech's 3) counted the same as a measured compartment temperature. Now only measured performance scores. Everything else is still recorded, printed and photographed; it just does not move the number.

```
today · of 52 appliance checks: 32 score, 9 are work performed, 7 are your judgement, 4 are readings with no agreed band yet
```

The argument for: a health score should be something we measured, and a customer paying for a report can tell the difference.
The argument against: your eye is often better than a thermometer, and this rule says your judgement is worth less than a number. That is the part I most want you to push back on — if a condition you can see should carry weight, tell me which one and how much.

PICK ONE

- ○ Right — only measured readings should score
- ○ Some conditions I judge by eye should score too — I will name them
- ○ Work performed should count for something after all
- ○ Everything should score, the way it did before

Which checks, and how much they should count

2 Is 75 / 25 the right split?

The health score is three-quarters measured condition and one-quarter lifecycle age, on the appliance side and now the HVAC side too. The condition part is defensible. The age part is an assumption: it says a fifteen-year-old system in perfect measured condition should score below a new one in identical condition. The counter-argument is the one Cayden made: at fifteen years they start having repeat failures, and scoring one 100% sets the customer up to be nickel-and-dimed. Both numbers are printed separately on the report, so a customer can see which half is which.

```
today · vitals 75% + age 25%, appliances and HVAC alike
```

For: age genuinely predicts failure, and a customer planning a kitchen wants to know what is near the end.
Against: it means a well-maintained older appliance can never score well, which is the opposite of the message we want to send to someone who has looked after their equipment.

PICK ONE

- ◯ Keep it at 75 / 25
- ◯ Age should count for less than 25%
- ◯ Drop age from the score entirely — report it separately
- ◯ Age should count for more than 25%

Why, and what weight you would use

---

3 Should band D still read “Plan ahead”?

A score of 60–69 prints as *Plan ahead* on a customer's report. Because a quarter of the score is age, an appliance can land there while measuring perfectly — and then a customer reads a replacement hint we did not intend and cannot support.

```
A Excellent · B Good · C Monitor · D Plan ahead · F Action recommended
```

The compiled whole-house review already avoids this by banding “needs attention” on the measured vitals alone, so age never triggers an attention flag. The grade label is the one remaining place where age can imply replacement.

PICK ONE

- ◯ Keep “Plan ahead”
- ◯ Rename it — wording below
- ◯ Drop the letter grades and print the numbers only

Your wording for band D

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4 Expected service life — correct the sourced table

Every lifecycle figure in the product comes from this table: appliance category by product tier. These are no longer my guesses — the marked rows sit on published figures (the NAHB household-component study for the mass column, with Sub-Zero's own statement behind luxury refrigeration), and the app still labels them drafts on a customer's report. Change any cell you think is wrong and leave the rest alone. My drafts were two to five years SHORT on several of these, which quietly lowered customers' scores.

Still guesses, and marked as such: undercounter icemakers and built-in grills have no published service-life figure anywhere I could find, so those two rows are Wilson estimates and the report says so. **The known gap:** there is still no row for outdoor refrigeration — an undercounter unit in a Texas outdoor kitchen inherits the built-in figure, twenty years for a luxury brand, which nobody believes. The Reynolds outdoor unit is hard-set to twelve years in the demo data as a stopgap.

	LUXURY		MASS PREMIUM		MASS	
Refrigeration published	draft 20		draft 16		draft 13	
Outdoor refrigeration no row today	no draft		no draft		no draft	
Dishwasher published	draft 15		draft 12		draft 9	
Cooking published	draft 20		draft 17		draft 14	
Icemaker Wilson estimate	draft 12		draft 10		draft 8	
Washer published	draft 16		draft 13		draft 10	
Dryer published	draft 18		draft 15		draft 13	
Ventilation published	draft 18		draft 16		draft 14	
Microwave published	draft 12		draft 10		draft 9	
Outdoor grill Wilson estimate	draft 15		draft 10		draft 7	

Write over anything that is wrong. A box left empty means the draft is fine.

Brands you would tier differently, or anything else about these numbers

The appliance protocols

52 checks across 11 appliance types. Six ask you for a number and two say what a good number is. Each card is one decision about that — and an open box, because the decision I wrote down is probably not the one that matters most to you.

5 Refrigeration: one condenser TD band, or two?

We apply one band — 15–30°F above ambient — to every refrigeration unit. An outdoor or undercounter enclosure changes heat rejection, so the same healthy compressor reads differently.

WHAT THE PROTOCOL CHECKS TODAY (5)

- M+T Compartment temperature performance actual & set point, fresh ~35–38°F, freezer near 0°F
- R Evaporator frost pattern
- M+T Condenser temperature & coil service 15–30°F above ambient
- R Components & operating sound
- R Airflow & filter status

M+T measured with a target band · M measured, no target · R rating only, no reading

PICK ONE

- ○ One band for all refrigeration is fine
- ○ Outdoor and undercounter need their own band
- ○ Every enclosure type needs its own band

BAND FOR OUTDOOR / UNDERCOUNTER e.g. up to 40 F above ambient

Refrigeration, your way — what actually predicts a failure, what we are missing, what is a waste of time

6

Dishwashers: add inlet water temperature?

Five ratings and no readings today. Wash performance is almost entirely a function of inlet water temperature and we do not take it. Proposed: temperature at the machine during fill, by thermocouple at the supply or the machine's own diagnostic readout. Roughly two minutes. It turns “wash performance seems fine” into a number that explains film on glassware without touching the dishwasher.

WHAT THE PROTOCOL CHECKS TODAY (5)

- R Seals & leak check
- R Filter & sump condition
- R Stored codes & controls
- R Test cycle & operating sound
- R Maintenance clean cycle

M+T measured with a target band · M measured, no target · R rating only, no reading

PICK ONE

- Accept — add it
- Change it — see my notes
- Reject — not worth the minutes

ACCEPTABLE BAND e.g. 120 F minimum at fill

INSTRUMENT thermocouple / machine readout

Dishwashers, your way — what actually predicts a failure, what we are missing, what is a waste of time

7

Dryers: vent static pressure, and a target on exhaust temperature

The highest-stakes protocol on the list. A restricting vent is a fire risk long before it is a dryer complaint, and it is invisible to every rating in the current set. We already ask for an exhaust temperature and state no target for it. Proposed: add static pressure with the manometer already on the van. The pair is diagnostic in a way neither is alone — temperature climbing *and* static climbing together means the duct is restricting downstream of anything we can reach.

A heat-pump dryer has no vent, so whatever we agree needs a “not applicable” path that does not read as a failed check.

WHAT THE PROTOCOL CHECKS TODAY (5)

- M Exhaust airflow & temperature measured, no target stated
- R Lint system & accessible cleaning
- R Drum, rollers & operating sound
- R Cycle / moisture-sensor operation

R Vent & utility connection

M+T measured with a target band · M measured, no target · R rating only, no reading

PICK ONE

- ○ Accept — add static pressure and band the temperature
- ○ Band the exhaust temperature only
- ○ Change it — see my notes
- ○ Reject — not worth the minutes

EXHAUST TEMPERATURE BAND e.g. under 160 F at the outlet

STATIC PRESSURE LIMIT e.g. 0.6 in. w.c. max

WHERE THE READING IS TAKEN at the transition / at the wall

Dryers and vents, your way — including what you would want photographed

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8 Ovens: what counts as accurate, and after how long?

We take a temperature and state no tolerance and no soak time. A reading at four minutes and a reading at twenty are different measurements — without a stated soak time this number cannot be compared between two techs, or between two years on the same oven.

WHAT THE PROTOCOL CHECKS TODAY (4)

R Door seals & condition

R Burner / element / flame test

M Temperature accuracy measured, no target stated

R Controls & safety operation

M+T measured with a target band · M measured, no target · R rating only, no reading

SET POINT WE TEST AT e.g. 350 F

SOAK TIME BEFORE READING e.g. 20 min, after cycling twice

ACCEPTABLE BAND e.g. within 25 F

INSTRUMENT & PLACEMENT e.g. probe at centre rack

Cooking, your way — ranges, cooktops and wall ovens all sit on this one protocol; say if they should not

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9 Icemakers: freeze cycle time against the model figure?

Twice-yearly service, so this protocol runs more often than any other and its cost per minute matters most. Proposed: time the freeze cycle and compare it to the model's published figure. It needs no tools, and a cycle drifting long is the earliest sign of scale or a loading condenser. The catch: the target is per model, not per category, so it only works if we keep model figures somewhere the app can read.

WHAT THE PROTOCOL CHECKS TODAY (5)

- R Ice pattern & production
- R Bin condition & cleaning
- R Cleaning / descale cycle
- R Condenser & airflow
- R Water, drain & filter

M+T measured with a target band · M measured, no target · R rating only, no reading

PICK ONE

- ○ Accept — and we will keep model figures
- ○ Accept, but use one band for all icemakers
- ○ Change it — see my notes
- ○ Reject — not worth the minutes

HOW FAR OFF IS TOO FAR e.g. 20% longer than published

Icemakers, your way — including whether water quality should be recorded on its own

10 Washers: hot fill temperature, or is that the dishwasher's job?

If one appliance per house establishes the supply temperature, the others may not need to repeat it. Or the laundry run is long enough that it is a genuinely different reading.

WHAT THE PROTOCOL CHECKS TODAY (5)

- R Hoses, fill & leak check
- R Drain performance
- R Wash / spin & vibration
- R Gasket, filter & cleaning condition
- R Stored codes & controls

M+T measured with a target band · M measured, no target · R rating only, no reading

PICK ONE

- ○ Take it on the washer too — it is a different run
- ○ Once per house is enough
- ○ Skip it entirely

Washers, your way — what actually predicts a failure, what we are missing, what is a waste of time

11 **Ventilation: blower current draw at high speed?**

Five ratings, no readings. Proposed: amp draw with the clamp meter already on the van — a cheap proxy for a loaded blower or a restricting duct, and unlike capture performance it is a number. Fair question whether it is worth the minute: a hood failing is an inconvenience, not a hazard.

WHAT THE PROTOCOL CHECKS TODAY (5)

- R Blower & capture performance
- R Filters / baffles
- R Blower sound & vibration
- R Controls, lights & heat sensor
- R Grease / duct-entry condition

M+T measured with a target band · M measured, no target · R rating only, no reading

PICK ONE

- ○ Accept — add amp draw
- ○ Change it — see my notes
- ○ Reject — not worth the minute

HOW WE JUDGE THE READING e.g. within 15% of nameplate FLA

Hoods, inserts and remote blowers, your way

12 **Microwaves: define the heating test**

We record a temperature rise with no defined load and no defined run time, which makes it incomparable to itself a year later. The standard test is a known volume of water at full power for a fixed time.

WHAT THE PROTOCOL CHECKS TODAY (5)

- R Door, seal & interlock
- M Heating performance measured, no target stated
- R Turntable, fan & airflow
- R Controls & stored faults
- R Interior / arcing condition

M+T measured with a target band · M measured, no target · R rating only, no reading

WATER LOAD e.g. 1000 ml at tap temperature

RUN TIME AT FULL POWER e.g. 60 s

ACCEPTABLE RISE e.g. 30 F minimum

Microwaves and speed ovens, your way — including whether this check is worth keeping at all

13
Grills: which temperature finding do we want?

Enrolled for function only. Wilson never cleans a grill and the report says so on the finding itself. Today we compare measured temperature against the lid gauge. Both readings are cheap; they say different things — gauge disagreement tells the customer their gauge lies, maximum temperature tells them the burners are tired.

WHAT THE PROTOCOL CHECKS TODAY (5)

- R Ignition & burner operation
- R Gas supply, connections & safety
- M Temperature performance measured vs lid gauge
- R Grates, burners & firebox condition document only — do not clean
- R Cart, hardware & rotisserie

M+T measured with a target band · M measured, no target · R rating only, no reading

PICK ONE

- Gauge disagreement
- Maximum temperature at full burner
- Both — they are two minutes together
- Neither is worth reporting

Built-in grills, your way — and where the line sits between documenting condition and cleaning

14
The generic fallback: should it exist?

Anything that does not resolve to a category lands on a three-check generic set with no readings. Worth asking whether an unrecognised appliance should be allowed to land there at all, or should block completion until someone classifies it.

A WashTower or stacked unit is enrolled and priced as two appliances and inspected on the washer and dryer protocols, so the separate laundry-centre set is largely unused.

PICK ONE

- Block completion until it is classified
- Allow the generic set, but flag the stop for review
- Allow it quietly — it is fine

Appliance types we service that have no protocol of their own yet

Open floor

The three questions I cannot answer from a config file.

15 **What are we not asking that you would want on every stop?**

Anything you check by habit that is not on the list above.

16 **Which of these is not worth the minutes?**

A protocol that takes ninety minutes an appliance is not a business. If something above is padding, say so now rather than in six months.

17 **Anything else**

About the tool, the report the customer sees, the way a stop is scheduled, or this sheet. Nothing is off topic.

Filled this in on a phone or laptop? Email the saved file to **cmayfield@wilsonappliance.com** and it goes straight into the shared sheet. Wrote on paper? Hand it in and it gets typed up once, by me.